The ‘TPP-86’ has been restructured and named ‘TPP-2006’ keeping in view the challenges of the 21st Century with particular reference to the process of the Economic Reforms. This is in harmony with the National Common Minimum Programme (NCMP) of the UPA Government.

Basically, the programme was targetted to the cause of poverty alleviation with the ‘direct attack’ approach. This experiment encouraged the Government to go for a whole Five-Year Plan with the slogan ‘Garibi Hatao’ (i.e the Sixth Plan, 1980–85). Over the years, the political changes at the Centre did not affect the programme and it has been continuously implented, more so due to its being of a high populist nature and known to the masses, as the experts believe.

C. MPLADS

The Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS) is the last of the Central Plans and latest to have been launched, too. The scheme was launched on December 23, 1993 with only Rs. 5 lakh given to each MPs which was increased to Rs. 1 crore in the year 1994–95. When the MPs did put a demand to increase the sum to Rs. 5 crore in 1997–98, finally the Government enhanced it to Rs. 2 crore since 1998–99. In April 2011 the corpus was enhanced to Rs. 5 crore while announcing the new guidelines for the scheme.

Basically, in the early 1990s there came a demand from the MPs cutting across the party line for such a scheme so that the fruits of development could directly reach the masses via their representatives. The Government of the time decided to go in for such a scheme and the MPLADS came.

Under this scheme the Members of Parliament[86] recommend some works (i.e. creation of fixed community assets, based on locally felt developmental needs) to the concerned District Magistrate. The scheme is governed by a set of guidelines, which have been comprehensively revised and issued in November 2005. Its performance has improved due to pro-active policy initiatives, focus monitoring and review.[87]

In recent years, many criticisms of the scheme came to the public notice which concerned either misappropriation of the funds or non-use of the funds, especially from the backward states. The people’s representative at